

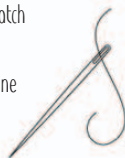


MAKING A QUILTED SEWING SET

Materials

FOR BOTH PROJECTS

- * Threads to match your fabrics
- * Sewing machine
- * Pins
- * Scissors
- * Iron & ironing board
- * Sewing needle



FOR NEEDLE BOOK

- * Nine 5 x 5cm (2 x 2in) pieces of coordinating fabrics with different prints
- * 11 x 11cm (4 1/2 x 4 1/2in) back cover fabric
- * 11 x 22.5cm (4 1/2 x 9in) lining fabric
- * 7.6cm (3in) elastic cord
- * 10 x 20cm (4 x 8in) wadding
- * 9.5 x 9.5cm (3 3/4 x 3 3/4in) felt, or aida cloth
- * Thread to match your felt
- * 2cm (3/4in) self-covered button in a coordinating fabric

NEEDLE BOOK

(SEE P87 FOR PICTURE)

Make the front cover

Arrange the coordinating fabrics in a nine-patch arrangement of your choice. With right sides together, stitch the three patches in each row together, then join the top, middle, and bottom rows. Press the seams. This forms the front cover of the needle book.

Join the front and back

Lay the front cover on top of the back cover fabric, right sides together. Pin along the edge that is to be the spine, then sew together to join the front and back covers. Open up and press the seam open.

Add the lining and the elastic

Lay the joined front and back covers on top of the lining fabric, right sides together. Fold the piece of elastic in half to create a loop. Place the loop between the back cover and the lining fabric, half way along the short side. The raw ends of the elastic should stick out of the side of the book by about 6mm (1/4in) and the loop should sit between the two layers of fabric. Pin the elastic in place, then pin around all four sides of the book.

Sew the sides and turn through

Sew around all four sides, leaving a 5cm (2in) gap along one long side. Sew over the ends of the elastic to secure in place. Snip off the four corners, taking care not to cut through the stitches. Turn the needle book to the right side through the gap. Carefully pull out all the corners with a pin, then iron.

Insert the wadding

Insert the piece of wadding inside the book through the gap in the stitches. Make sure it lies flat and even, then hand sew the gap closed. If you want to quilt your needle book, do it at this stage, before adding the felt page.

Attach the felt page

Place the piece of felt so that one of its edges sits at the centre fold of the book. Pin in place along this edge. Using a matching top thread and a bobbin thread that matches the back cover fabric, topstitch along the edge, leaving a 2mm (1/16in) seam allowance.

Stitch on the button

Position the button on the front cover so it aligns with the elastic loop. Sew it in place, only catching the front cover fabric so the stitches are not visible on the other side.

